

ATTRACTION: Dungeshwari Temple, Pragbodhi

ALTERNATIVE NAMES:

Dungeshwari Hills Caves

LOCATION:

Gaya

DISTRICT / REGION:

Gaya, Bihar

CATEGORY:

Religious Site / Heritage Site

OVERVIEW:

Dungeshwari Temple and the surrounding caves, located in the Dungeshwari Hills (Pragbodhi) along the Falgu river, are deeply intertwined with the spiritual journey of Lord Buddha. Though the caves may lack conventional visual appeal, they are renowned for offering a surreal experience and a sense of transcendental energy. It is believed that these caves sheltered Lord Buddha for six years before he travelled to Bodh Gaya to attain enlightenment.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION:

Located about 12-15 kms from Gaya along the Falgu river, the Dungeshwari Hills are home to a series of caves that now house several temples. The physical appearance of the caves is modest, but they are highly significant for their spiritual atmosphere. One of the primary cave temples in this area is dedicated to the Hindu goddess, Dungeshwari. The site is widely visited by pilgrims who are following the trail of Lord Buddha's historical journey.

HISTORICAL OR CULTURAL SIGNIFICANCE:

The site is highly significant in Buddhist history and pilgrimage, as it represents the period of extreme asceticism practiced by Lord Buddha before he moved to Bodh Gaya. The Chinese pilgrim Hiuen Tsang historically mentioned these hills in his travelogue, adding to their archaeological and historical value.

LEGENDS, STORIES, OR TRADITIONS:

According to tradition, the caves in Dungeshwari Hills protected Lord Buddha for six years before he descended to the sacred town of Bodhgaya to attain enlightenment. It is believed that the transcendental energy of his meditation still lingers, offering a surreal experience to visitors.

KEY HIGHLIGHTS:

- Believed to have sheltered Lord Buddha for six years before his enlightenment.
- Contains a cave temple dedicated to the Hindu goddess Dungeshwari.
- Mentioned in the travelogue of the ancient Chinese pilgrim Hiuen Tsang.
- Located along the scenic Falgu river.

VISITOR INFORMATION:

Best Time To Visit:

October to March

Opening Hours:

05:00 AM - 05:00 PM

Entry Fee:

Not Mentioned

Duration Recommended:

Not Mentioned

Photography:

Allowed

Accessibility Information:

Not Mentioned

FACILITIES:

- Parking
- Drinking Water
- Videography & Photography Allowed

TRANSPORTATION:

Nearest Airport:

Gaya International Airport

Distance From Airport:

19 Kms

Nearest Railway Station:

Gaya Junction

Distance From Railway Station:

14 Kms

Nearest Bus Stand:

Bhusanda Bus Stand (Pvt.)

Distance From Bus Stand:

08 Kms

Road Connectivity:

Located 12-15 kms from Gaya.

Nearest Tourist Information Centre:

Tourist Information Centre, Gaya Junction (14 Kms)

Nearest Police Station:

Bodhgaya Police Station (13 Km), Ph : 0631-2200741

Nearest Medical Facility:

Sadar Hospital, Gaya, Mob : 9470003263; Anugrah Narayan Magadh Medical Collage & Hospital, Gaya, Ph : 0631-221074

NEARBY ATTRACTIONS:

- Mahabodhi Mandir (13 Kms)
- 80 feet Buddha statue (13 Kms)
- Thai Temple (13 Kms)
- Vishnupad Mandir (12 Kms)
- Mangla Gauri Mandir (11 Kms)

FESTIVALS AND EVENTS:

Not Mentioned

LOCAL CULTURE AND EXPERIENCES:

Offers a surreal experience for those seeking transcendental energy and peace, often visited by pilgrims tracing Lord Buddha's journey.

LOCAL FOOD AND CUISINE:

Not Mentioned

SHOPPING AND SOUVENIRS:

Not Mentioned

ACCOMMODATION:

- Vishnu View Hotel
- Ajatsatru Hotel
- Hotel Mantra Regency
- Hotel Royal View

HOTELS:

- Vishnu View Hotel, Mob : 9608556289
- Ajatsatru Hotel, Mob : 9798881223
- Hotel Mantra Regency, Mob : 9973357885
- Hotel Royal View, Mob : 9431224222

LOCAL GUIDES:

- Harendra kumar, Mob : 9708472519
- Sanjeev Kumar, Mob : 7488688556
- Prakash Renukarjun, Mob : 8809630151
- Gautam Kumar, Mob : 9934058927
- Dinu Kumar Sinha, Mob : 9199661740
- Srikant Kr Mishra, Mob : 9934794969
- Deepak kumar, Mob : 7992452814
- Raviranjana Mishra, Mob : 9939086249

TRAVEL OPERATORS:

- Gupta Tour & Travels - 8507192638
- Vishal Tour & Travels - 9006169000
- Maa Vaishnavi Tour & Travels - 8083329781
- Surya Services - 9431094940

IMPORTANT FACTS:

- Located 12-15 kms from Gaya along the Falgu river.
- Mentioned by the Chinese pilgrim Hiuen Tsang.
- Houses both Buddhist caves and a temple for a Hindu goddess.

RETRIEVAL SUMMARY:

Dungeshwari Temple, also known as Pragbodhi, is located in the Dungeshwari Hills about 12-15 kms from Gaya along the Falgu river. It is famous for the caves that protected Lord Buddha for six years prior to his enlightenment in Bodhgaya. The site also includes a temple dedicated to the Hindu goddess Dungeshwari and was mentioned by the ancient Chinese pilgrim Hiuen Tsang. Open from 05:00 AM to 05:00 PM, it is widely visited by pilgrims. The site is 19 km from Gaya International Airport and offers basic facilities like parking and drinking water. Nearby attractions include Mahabodhi Mandir (13 Kms) and Vishnupad Mandir (12 Kms).

QUESTION-ANSWER FACTS:

Q: What is this attraction known for?

A: It is known for the caves where Lord Buddha is believed to have meditated for six years before attaining enlightenment in Bodhgaya.

Q: Where is it located?

A: It is located in the Dungeshwari Hills (Pragbodhi), about 12-15 kms from Gaya, along the Falgu river.

Q: What are the nearby attractions?

A: Nearby attractions include Mahabodhi Mandir (13 Kms), 80 feet Buddha statue (13 Kms), Thai Temple (13

Kms), Vishnupad Mandir (12 Kms), and Mangla Gauri Mandir (11 Kms).

Q: How can visitors reach it?

A: The site is 19 km from Gaya International Airport, 14 km from Gaya Junction, and 8 km from Bhusanda Bus Stand.

Q: What facilities are available?

A: Facilities include parking, drinking water, and permitted videography & photography.

KEYWORDS:

Dungeshwari Temple, Pragbodhi, Gaya, Dungeshwari Hills, Lord Buddha, Falgu river, Bodhgaya, enlightenment, Hiuen Tsang, Buddhist pilgrimage, Hindu goddess Dungeshwari, Bihar tourism